PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, March 17, 2026

Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center , 501 N. Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members: Director Virginia LaForte (Committee Chair); Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; and Director Rashelle Chase-Miller

District Student Council Representative: Alexander Olberter

Other Attendees:
Kara Bradshaw – Confidential Executive Assistant; Board Clerk
Andrew Colas – Colas-Hoffman
Stephanie Coyle – Colas-Hoffman
Joanna Evenson – Director, Project Management & Construction
Dr. Jon Franco – Senior Chief of Operations
TJ Hopkins – Contracted Senior Director, Bond Program
Liz Large – Contracted Senior Legal Advisor
Sarah Norman – Executive Director for PPS, Procedeo
Rosanne Powell – Senior Manager, Board of Education

Call to Order / Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 4:30 pm. Board Members and staff at the dais introduced themselves.

Public Comment

Time: 4:32 pm

- Elizabeth Super: Raised concerns regarding safety at Powell Park on behalf of a student athlete and urged for progress on the field renovations and for the presentation materials to reflect needed softball improvements.
- Brian Kinion: Requested clarity on progress of West Sylvan athletic improvements, including potential reevaluation of work that has already taken place, and urged for prioritization of the project.
- Madeline Moya: Raised concerns about the lack of equity considerations in seismic upgrade plans and urged clearer accountability and equitable allocation of funds to improve student safety.
- Nate McCoy: National Association of Minority Contractors (NAMC), the organization who reviewed PPS's Equity in Contracting report, expressed support for Procedeo and bond contractors, noting ongoing efforts to advance equity in contracting while affirming progress toward modernization goals.

Jefferson High School Update
Time: 4:46 pm

Staff: Joanna Evenson, TJ Hopkins, Sarah Norman

Colas-Hoffman Representatives: Andrew Colas and Stephanie Coyle

Staff and representatives from Colas-Hoffman provided a summary of the feasibility study for Jefferson High School, which examined the potential use of a shell option as part of the modernization project. It was reported that while the shell option may have resulted in modest timeline savings, it was ultimately not selected due to safety considerations and an increased cost. Staff reviewed project timelines and capacity needs, noting that early occupancy would not be feasible, though some services may be available sooner, and that temporary classroom spaces would be required to accommodate the anticipated increase in student enrollment during construction. Board members asked questions and expressed appreciation for the analysis, noting that the feasibility study provided value in informing decision-making and identifying efficiencies.

Bond Athletic Projects Update

Time: 5:01 pm

An update was provided on athletic facilities projects, including current status' and anticipated timelines. It was noted that multiple projects remain in progress, with timelines influenced by planning requirements and external coordination. Updates included ongoing work at several sites, with specific challenges such as utility coordination, land use requirements, and continued negotiations with partners. It was also noted that project plans remain subject to change based on these factors, and that implementation is being addressed as each project advances.

Bond Audit—Status Update

Time: 5:17 pm

Staff: TJ Hopkins

Staff provided an update on the status of bond audit recommendations #7 and #8 from Year 2, and recommendations #1 and #6 from Year 4, indicating that all recommendations have been fully implemented. Information was shared regarding the implementation process, including prior work completed before the current team, and efforts to standardize reporting practices. Board members asked questions and requested additional materials related to evaluation tools developed through the process.

Procurement and Land Use Updates

Time: 5:26 pm

Staff: TJ Hopkins

Staff provided an update on procurement timelines and land use processes for multiple school projects, including for the modernization of Cleveland, Ida B. Wells, and Jefferson High Schools. Recent progress was noted, including the completion of a historic resource review for Jefferson High School, and next steps in project planning and approvals were outlined.

Other Business and Future Agenda Items

Time: 5:30 pm

Committee Chair Virginia La Forte highlighted the anticipated agenda for the next meeting of the Committee in April, which is anticipated to include the districtwide seismic improvement plan and indoor air quality in schools. It was noted that the topic of indoor air quality is also being considered in the Policy Committee as part of the Climate Crisis Response Policy.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 5:31 pm by Committee Chair Virginia La Forte.

Submitted by:
Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools